

demand. The Conference Board of Canada estimates that *40 percent of all new jobs will be in the skilled trades and technology industry by 2020.*

I can't tell you how many people I've met who started on the shop floor and ended up in the chairman's suite. It doesn't always happen that way, of course, but the trades are places where upward mobility is still possible. Compare that to the business world, where it's a slow, arduous climb. "Cold hard cash" industries offer jobs with real revenue and ample employment opportunities, two things that can be hard to come by in white-collar industries. When I speak at high schools, I make a point of saying, "Look, kids—the stigma of not having a university degree is complete bull. You want an income as soon as you can get one, and you want to be able to provide for the family you'll have someday. That could mean a trade. And that's okay! In fact, it's great."

If you think a cold hard cash career might be right for you, do some research. Use the information that follows as a starting point and dig around online for more. Talk to your school counselor about what classes you could take to prepare you for trade school. Even better, talk to people who are actually working in these fields. And next time your parents give you grief about not going to university, show them the numbers. In this tenuous job market, they should rejoice that you are pursuing a sustainable career with good prospects—and the opportunity to make lots of cash.

TEN COLD HARD CASH CAREERS

All of the 10 cold hard cash careers that follow ranked among the top 50 jobs in a 2013 edition of *Canadian Business*. I've provided some basic statistics for each—the median annual salary, change in salary between 2006 and 2012, and growth in number of employees over the same six-year span. For some, I've included projected job openings for every person seeking